

# CHAPTER EIGHT: STORYTELLING

*So write your story as it needs to be written. Write it honestly, and tell it as best you can. I'm not sure that there are any other rules. Not ones that matter.*

—Neil Gaiman

The art of telling stories with a group might seem like a daunting one, but fortunately, with some preparation and practice, it soon becomes second nature. This chapter discusses some basics every Storyteller should know, from building a setting and creating characters to measuring and ending stories, and provides advice on common issues such as handling problem players or scheduling game sessions.

## Setting the Stage

Before any other preparations can begin, the question needs to be answered about what kind of chronicle the Storyteller is going to run. There are two most commonly-used chronicle setups: story driven and character driven.

### Story Driven

As the term suggests, a story-driven chronicle begins with the Storyteller having an idea for a tale she thinks would interest the players. For example,

a Storyteller might decide she wants to tell a sort of detective noir story with a **Changeling** twist, where the characters must solve mysteries to expose a web of corruption at the heart of their local court.

One of the advantages of a story-driven chronicle is the focus — since the Storyteller has a clear idea of the basic type of story at the outset, it's easy to make sure all the characters fit into the world that's being drawn up. Whether the Storyteller pre-generates characters for the players, or simply guides the process to ensure they create roles that fit the foundational themes and elements, the end result is a tight, purpose-built cast. In addition, the players know what they're getting up front, or at least have a good idea of the theme and mood they can expect, which means they can prepare themselves for that type of story.

As strong as story-driven chronicles can be, however, it's important for the Storyteller to remember that this is still a collaborative process — the players must also be able to put their own stamp on their characters and the chronicle as a whole. She must